



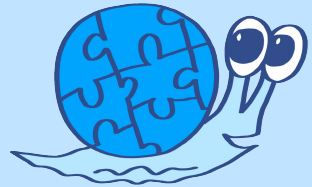
Citation Location Needed

Mario Morvan – User:Yoctera



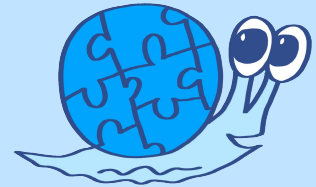


→ Specifying **in-source location** in citations ('p', 'page', 'pages', etc.)





→ Specifying **in-source location** in citations ('p', 'page', 'pages', etc.)
lowers the barrier to verification





How many *located* citations? What associated verification cost?

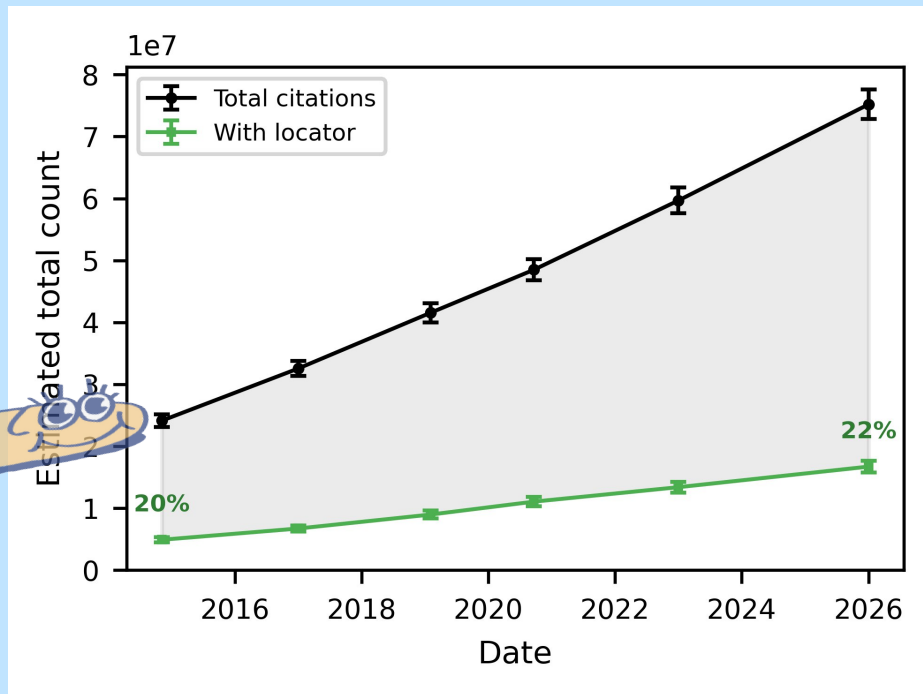
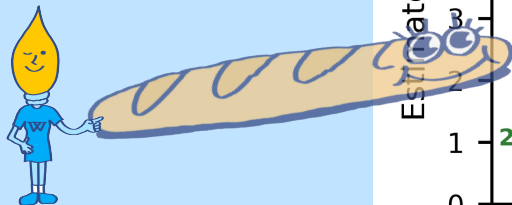
- 6 random samples of 20,000 EnWiki articles from 2014 to 2026
- precise parsing of references and locators
- retrieved length of books and articles (from Open Library & CrossRef)





En Wikipedia from 2014 to 2026:

x3 citations

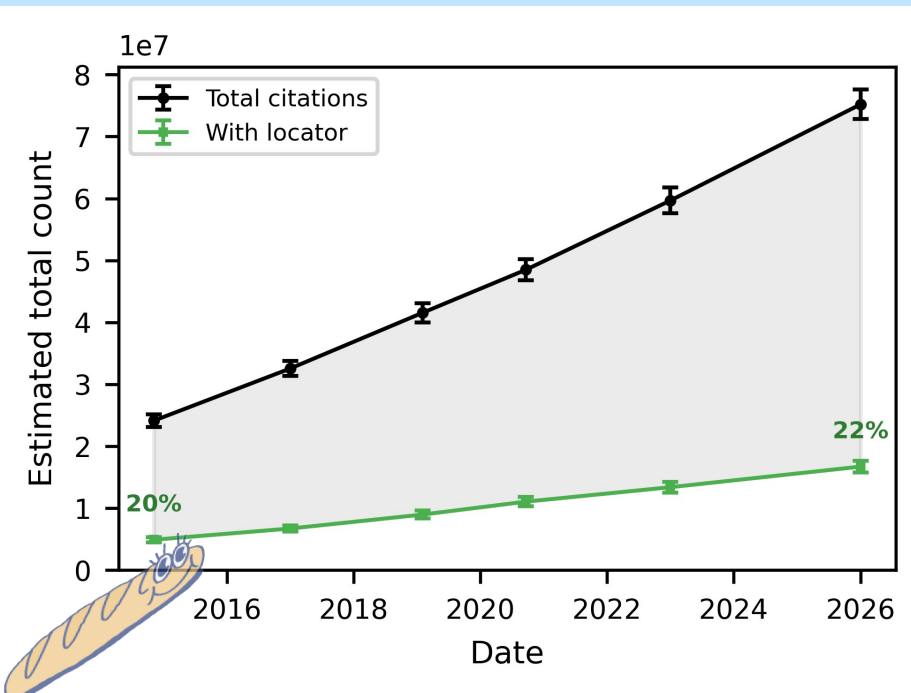




En Wikipedia from 2014 to 2026:

x3 citations

1 in 5 citations has locator(s)



6 most represented citation types



TEMPLATE	% CITATIONS	% PAGES	% PAGE	% OTHER
<code>{{cite web}}</code>	42%	0.3%	0.8%	0.9% (<i>quote</i>)
<i>untemplated</i>	23%	4.7%	15%	–
<code>{{cite news}}</code>	14%	3.2%	9.7%	1.3% (<i>quote, department</i>)
<code>{{cite book}}</code>	6.8%	35%	33%	13% (<i>chapter, quote, at, ...</i>)
<code>{{cite journal}}</code>	5.0%	77%	8.3%	1.3% (<i>quote, at</i>)
<code>{{sfn}}</code>	4.3%	19%	67%	2.4% (<i>loc</i>)

En Wikipedia 2026-01-01



page and pages most frequent locators



TEMPLATE	% CITATIONS	% PAGES	% PAGE	% OTHER
<code>{{cite web}}</code>	42%	0.3%	0.8%	0.9% (<i>quote</i>)
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En Wikipedia 2026-01-01

Only few other locators



TEMPLATE	% CITATIONS	% PAGES	% PAGE	% OTHER
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En Wikipedia 2026-01-01



web-based citations



TEMPLATE	% CITATIONS	% PAGES	% PAGE	% OTHER
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En Wikipedia 2026-01-01



citations with many page(s) locators



TEMPLATE	% CITATIONS	% PAGES	% PAGE	% OTHER
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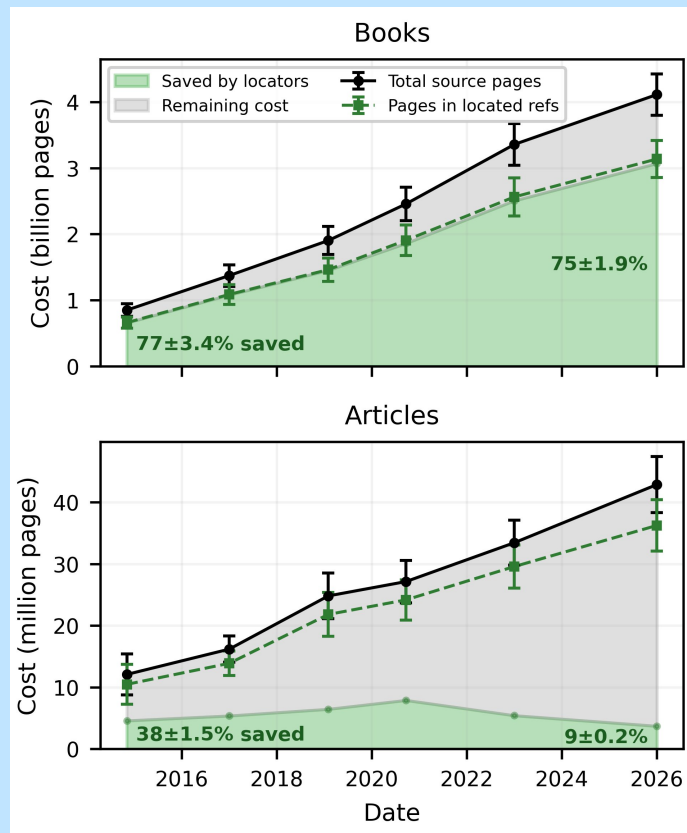
Counting Source Pages from References on En Wikipedia

Books :

- 3 billion pages saved | 1 billion left

Articles :

- 4 million pages saved | 38 million left





Thank you!

Next steps : multilingual + locator need + community tools

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Parser code: <https://github.com/mrmvn/wikiloc>

Blog post: <https://mariomorvan.org/citation-location-needed/>

Contact : mario.morvan@pm.me